

Butterfly Pea Flower Tea

What it is?

- Butterfly pea flower tea (*Clitoria ternatea*) — a caffeine-free herbal tea made from the blue petals.
- Naturally rich in anthocyanins (ternatins) , which give the deep blue color.
- Add a squeeze of lemon/lime and it changes from blue to purple (pH effect).

Benefits (and the flipside)

Pros

- Caffeine-free hydration; easy evening drink.
- High in antioxidant pigments; works as a natural food/drink color.
- Early research suggests a mild blunting of post-meal blood sugar (don't treat it as medicine).
- Gentle, earthy taste; great for mocktails and iced teas.

Cons / cautions

- Human evidence is limited overall.
- May lower blood sugar or blood pressure a bit—monitor if you take related meds.
- Pregnancy/breastfeeding: safety unclear; best to skip unless your doctor okays it.
- Use petals/tea bags only (not seeds). Very strong brews can upset the stomach.

How to take it

- Hot brew: 1 tea bag (or ~1–2 g petals) in 250 ml near-boiling water; steep 5–10 min, covered. Optional: lemon/lime (color flip), honey, mint, lemongrass, or ginger.
- Cold brew: 1 tea bag per 250–300 ml cold water; steep 4–8 hours in the fridge; strain. Serve over ice; add citrus to turn purple.
- How much: Start with 1 cup/day, then 1–2 cups if you feel fine. It's caffeine-free, so night use is okay.
- Storage: Keep the tin sealed, dry, and away from light; best within 6–12 months for peak color and aroma.



Masala Spiced Chai

What it is

- Masala Spiced Chai — a black tea blended with warming spices (typically cardamom, cinnamon, ginger, clove, black pepper).
- Contains caffeine (rough ballpark: ~30–60 mg per cup depending on brew strength).
- Usually enjoyed with milk and a touch of sugar or honey; rich, sweet-spicy, and energizing.



Benefits Pros

- Alertness + focus from caffeine and L-theanine in black tea.
- Digestive comfort —ginger/cardamom can help nausea/bloating; cinnamon/clove add antimicrobial/antioxidant punch.
- Warming, soothing drink for cold/rainy days; pairs well with milk for a more filling snack.

Cons / cautions

- Caffeine timing: can disturb sleep—avoid late evening. Keep daily caffeine <400 mg (≤ 200 mg if pregnant).
- Acid reflux/stomach sensitivity: spices + strong tea can aggravate some people.
- Iron absorption: black tea tannins reduce iron uptake—avoid within 1–2 hours of iron-rich meals or supplements.
- Sugar load: café-style chai can be very sweet; control sweetener at home.
- Allergies/intolerances: switch to lactose-free or plant milk if dairy bothers you.

How to take it

- Quick mug (no-fuss):
 - 1 tsp loose blend or 1 tea bag in 250 ml freshly boiled water.
 - Steep 3–5 min (longer = stronger/more bitter).
 - Add 60–120 ml milk (dairy or plant) and sweeten to taste.
- Stovetop “proper” chai (richer):
 - Simmer 200 ml water + 150 ml milk with 2 heaped tsp blend for 5–7 min on low.
 - Sweeten (1–2 tsp sugar/honey), strain into cup. (For extra kick, add a slice of fresh ginger while simmering.)
- Iced chai / chai latte:
 - Brew double-strength (2x tea), chill, pour over ice with cold milk; optional vanilla or a pinch of nutmeg.
- How much: 1–2 cups/day is reasonable. If pregnant or caffeine-sensitive, cap at one small cup and brew lighter.

Lemon Balm Tea

WHAT IT IS

- Lemon Balm (*Melissa officinalis*) herbal tea — caffeine-free.
- Light lemony, mint-family leaves; used for calm and digestion.

BENEFITS (and downsides)

- May help reduce stress/anxiety and improve sleep (mild, natural calm).
- Gentle digestive relief: bloating, gas, queasy stomach.
- Can ease tension headaches for some.
- Antioxidants; nice evening drink.
- Downsides/cautions: Evidence is mild; not a medicine. May increase drowsiness—go easy if you take sedatives/sleep meds. Use caution with thyroid issues/meds (rare interactions reported). Pregnancy/breastfeeding: not enough safety data—skip unless your doctor says OK.



HOW TO TAKE IT

- **Hot brew:** 1–2 tsp dried leaves (or 1 tea bag) in 250 ml hot water (90–100°C). **Steep 5–10 min**, cover, strain.
- **For sleep:** 1 cup **30–60 min before bed**.
- **Cold brew:** Same amount in cold water; **fridge 4–8 hrs**, strain.
- **Add-ins:** honey, lemon, mint, or ginger.
- **How much:** start with **1 cup/day**, then 1–2 cups if you feel good. Avoid right before tasks needing full alertness.
- **Storage:** airtight jar, cool/dark place; best within 6–12 months.

Hawthorn Tea

WHAT IT IS

- Hawthorn (*Crataegus*) herbal tea/extract—made from the berries, leaves, or flowers.
- Tart–apple, mildly floral taste. Traditionally used for **heart and circulation**.
- Caffeine-free.



BENEFITS (and downsides)

Pros

- May **support heart function** and circulation (research uses standardized extracts; tea is gentler).
- Can mildly **lower blood pressure** and ease “fluttery” palpitations in some people.
- Antioxidant-rich; calming, after-meal friendly.

Cons / cautions

- **Not a medicine** or a replacement for heart drugs.
- Possible side effects: **dizziness, nausea, headache**, or palpitations if strong.
- **Interactions:** can intensify effects of **BP/heart meds** (beta-blockers, ACE inhibitors, calcium-channel blockers, nitrates, **digoxin**) and may add to **blood thinners** (aspirin/warfarin/clopidogrel).
- **Pregnancy/breastfeeding:** avoid—safety unclear.
- If you have heart disease or take heart/BP/diabetes meds, **talk to your doctor first**. Stop 1–2 weeks before planned surgery.

HOW TO TAKE IT

- **Tea:** 1–2 tsp dried berries/leaves/flowers (or 1 tea bag) per 250 ml boiling water. **Steep 10–15 min**, strain.
- Start with **1 cup/day**; if you feel fine, up to **2–3 cups/day**. Take with food if your stomach is sensitive.
- **Flavor ideas:** honey + lemon; or blend with hibiscus/rose/ginger.
- **Extract/capsules:** only with clinician guidance (research doses often **300–600 mg/day** of standardized extract, divided).
- **Spacing:** keep **2–3 hours** away from prescription meds.
- **Storage:** airtight, cool, and dark; best within **6–12 months**.

Mullein Leaves Tea

WHAT IT IS

- **Mullein leaves** (*Verbascum thapsus*) herbal tea — caffeine-free.
- Traditionally used as a **lung/respiratory soother**; mild, earthy taste.



BENEFITS (and downsides)

- **Pros:** May ease **dry, irritated cough**, help **loosen mucus**, and calm a scratchy throat (demulcent + gentle expectorant).
 - Naturally **soothing** and hydrating; nice for cold/rainy days.
 - **Cons/cautions:** Evidence is limited—use as a comfort drink, not medicine. The tiny **leaf hairs can irritate the throat** if not filtered well. Rare skin/plant allergies possible.
- Pregnancy/breastfeeding:** safety unclear—skip unless your doctor says OK. If you have chronic lung disease or severe symptoms, see a clinician.

HOW TO TAKE IT

- **Hot tea:** 1–2 tsp dried leaves (or 1 bag) per 250 ml **near-boiling water**. **Steep 10–15 min**, then **strain through a fine mesh/coffee filter** to catch the hairs.
- **Add-ins:** honey, lemon, or ginger.
- **How much:** start with **1 cup/day**; up to **2–3 cups** short-term if you feel fine.
- **Steam option (for congestion):** pour hot water over 1–2 tbsp leaves in a bowl, tent with a towel, breathe gently **5–10 min**. Avoid burns; stop if breathing feels worse.
- **Storage:** airtight, cool, dark; best within **6–12 months**.